

Besides this, overall start-up time and stability have also improved with the update. Thunderbird 13 requirements on Windows have also changed—now it will work on Windows XP Service Pack 2 or later. It is also available for Mac OS X and Linux. You can right away upgrade your system using the built-in update tool or wait for the automatic update notification.

The licensing on Thunderbird 13 has also been revised like that in Firefox. Thunderbird source and binaries are released under the Mozilla Public Licence 2.0. Feel free to consult MPL 2.0 FAQ, if you need further information.

Open Source Robotics Foundation launched!

Willow Garage, a robotics research lab and technology incubator, has launched a non-profit organisation called the Open Source Robotics Foundation (OSRF) with an aim to support the development, distribution, and adoption of open source software for use in robotics research, education, and product development.

"It's always been the intention of Willow Garage to create an independent body that can take our initial work in open source robotics and see it grow beyond the confines of a single organisation. The reality is that the popularity of open source robotics in general, and ROS specifically, has grown beyond our wildest expectations. Willow Garage will enthusiastically support the goals of the OSRF," said Steve Cousins, CEO, Willow Garage. As part of its first initiative, the OSRF has also disclosed plans to participate in the DARPA Robotics Challenge which will be launched in October this year.

Protecode announces its cloud-based open source licence management solution

Protecode, a leading provider of open source licence management solutions, has launched the hosted version of its popular System 4 open source scanning and licence management solution. ProtecodeCloud is a Software as a Service (SaaS) code scanning tool that allows organisations to manage open source licences and obligations in the cloud, without having to invest in infrastructure and costly upgrades.

Because it is a hosted solution, there is no software to install or update. Organisations sign up through Protecode's secure website at www.protecode.com, and are given 30 day access to ProtecodeCloud to scan their code, detect open source components, and interact with the analysis reports. ProtecodeCloud is suited to any size of organisation that currently develops its software in the cloud. Organisations can take advantage of ProtecodeCloud in a public or private cloud setting.

With ProtecodeCloud, organisations can automatically create Bill of Materials (BoM) software that includes a list of all open source and third party projects within it. Reports on licences, copyrights, licence obligations, licence compatibilities, security vulnerabilities and export control designations are available with a single click. ProtecodeCloud is also the only product currently available that can read and create Software Package Data Exchange (SPDX) standard files.

OpenSUSE 12.2 beta to have 3.4 Linux Kernel

After the first and only beta for version 12.2, the OpenSUSE project is likely to bring its final beta version on July 11, 2012. Originally, the release was scheduled on May 24, but got delayed due to issues with build service. It is important to note that this final version



will include the latest 3.4 Linux Kernel, with GNOME 3.4 and KDE SC 4.8.3 as the desktop environments. You can download the first beta as a DVD ISO image file for 32-bit and 64-bit systems.

The version is expected to have certain bug fixes and improved overall stability of distribution. If you happen to test the release, OpenSUSE encourages that you give your feedback and report bugs, if you find any.

Instapaper arrives on Android

Instapaper lets you store Web pages for later viewing and this useful app is now arriving on Android. The best part about the app is that when it stores the Web pages, it omits all the unnecessary ads and related data and stores clean text in a simple user interface. The app can be downloaded from Google Play at a cost of \$2.99 (Rs 164.90). Moreover, it allows users to manipulate the font size and style just as they could with any eReader application.

